

Sales of large-display smartphones to more than double in 2013

Phablets are a hot product with their global shipments set to more than double this year. Derived from words 'phone' and 'tablet,' phablet is a smartphone with a large display sized 12.7 cm (5 inches) or bigger. Shipments of phablets in 2013 are forecast to reach 60.4 million units—up a notable 136 per cent from 25.6 million last year—according to an IHS iSuppli market report.

Chinese phone makers took the lead in new phablet launches at this year's *Consumer Electronics Show (CES)*. Huawei Technologies showcased Ascend Mate, which so far appears to be the world's largest smartphone with a 15.5cm (6.1-inch) display. Huawei rival ZTE launched 6.9mm thick Grand S, which is claimed to be the world's thinnest quad-core smartphone.

Eaton gets new MD for India

Nitin Chalke has been named managing director of Eaton in India, reporting to Curt Hutchins, president-Asia Pacific. Chalke succeeds Raja Kochar, who has decided to leave Eaton to pursue other career interests.

In this new role, Chalke will be responsible for developing and executing a broad-based, proactive strategy to support Eaton's growth objectives in India.

Narayanan named MD, IBM India

Vanitha Narayanan has been appointed as managing director of IBM India. She takes over from Shanker Annaswamy, who will continue to remain in IBM as senior advisor to the corporation on India enterprise. Both Narayanan and Annaswamy will report to Jim Bramante, senior vice president, IBM Growth Markets Unit.

Brocade appoints Carney as chief executive officer

Brocade has appointed networking industry veteran Lloyd Carney as chief executive officer. In addition to his role as

CEO, Carney will join Brocade's board of directors. Carney succeeds Michael Klayko, who has served as CEO since 2005.

Avnet appoints GIS leader, Asia Pacific

Avnet Technology Solutions, a global IT solutions distributor and operating group of Avnet, Inc., has appointed Max Leng-Jin Chan as vice president, global information solutions (GIS), technology solutions, Asia Pacific.

Spice Global appoints new CIO

Spice Global has appointed Ozi Amanat as chief investment officer. The appointment of Amanat is in line with the group's strategy to maximise shareholder value and diversify into emerging areas of business.

In this new role, Amanat will be responsible for devising strategies for growth through new businesses, managing and monitoring group's portfolio of assets, and acting as the liaison between the investors and group and streamlining risk management.



Global IT spending likely to increase 4.2 per cent

Worldwide IT spending is projected to total \$3.7 trillion in 2013—a 4.2 per cent increase from 2012 spending of \$3.6 trillion—according to the latest forecast by Gartner, Inc.

Gartner analysts said much of this spending increase is a result of

projected gains in the value of foreign currencies versus the dollar. When measured in constant dollars, 2013 spending growth is forecast to be 3.9 per cent.

Worldwide devices spending, which includes PCs, tablets, mobile phones and printers, is forecast

to reach \$666 billion—up 6.3 per cent from 2012.

Samsung surpasses Apple as the top global semiconductor customer

Samsung Electronics and Apple both dominated semiconductor demand in

2012, although Samsung overtook Apple as the top worldwide semiconductor customer, according to Gartner, Inc. Based on analysis of the design total available market (TAM), Samsung and Apple together consumed \$45.3 billion of semiconductors in 2012—an increase of \$7.9 billion from 2011—to represent 15 per cent of total semiconductor demand, while the total semiconductor market decreased by 3 per cent overall.

“Although Samsung and Apple continue to go from strength to strength, other leading electronic equipment makers fared less well, and six of the top 10 reduced their demand in 2012,” said Masatsune Yamaji, principal research analyst at Gartner.

“In addition to a weak macroeconomic situation, a dramatic change in consumer demand contributed to a reduction in semiconductor demand in